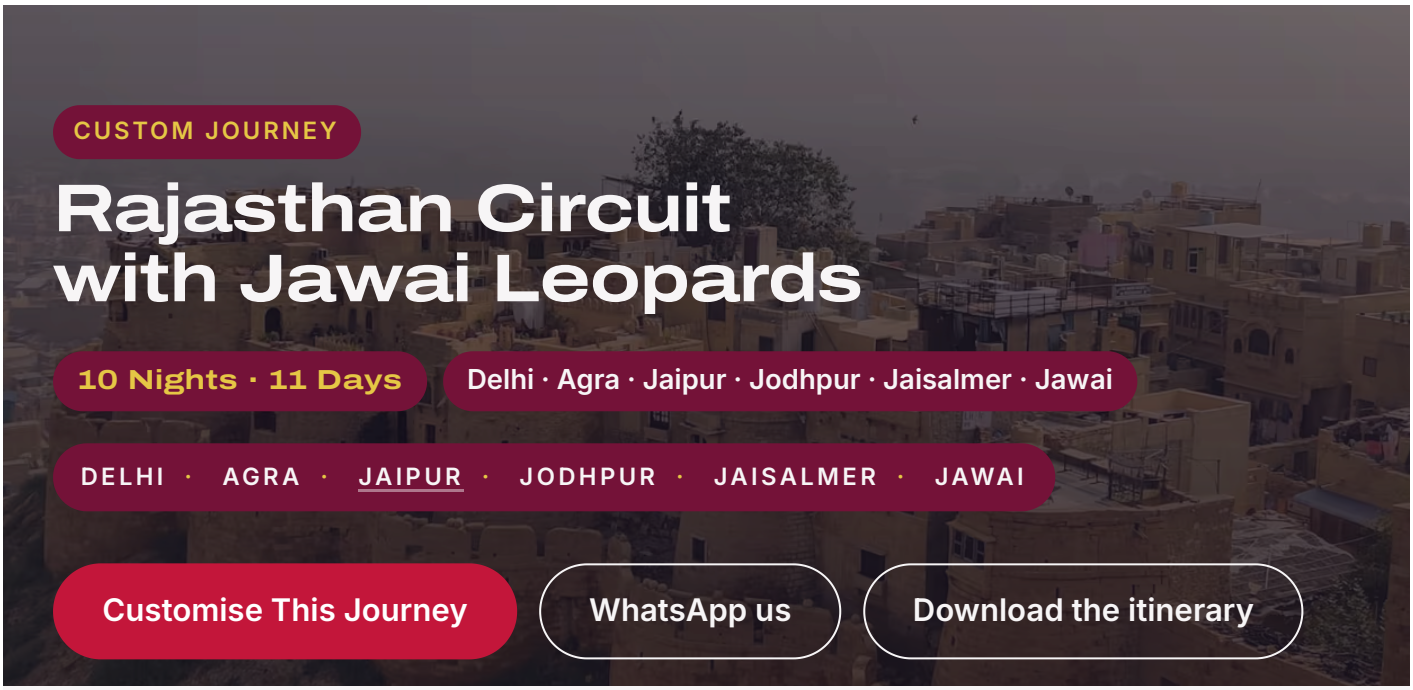
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CUSTOM JOURNEY

Rajasthan Circuit with Jawai Leopards

10 Nights · 11 Days Delhi · Agra · Jaipur · Jodhpur · Jaisalmer · Jawai

DELHI · AGRA · JAIPUR · JODHPUR · JAISALMER · JAWAI

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DURATION
10 Nights · 11 Days

ROUTE
Delhi → Jawai

PACE
Moderate

BEST SEASON
October to March

IDEAL FOR
First-Timers, Couples, Families

If one journey could hold the whole of Rajasthan, it would be this one. From Delhi and the marble of the Taj into the pink city of Jaipur, the blue city of Jodhpur, the golden dunes of Jaisalmer, and finally to the granite hills of Jawai, where leopards live among the rocks and the shepherd villages — it is the definitive first journey to India: forts rising from the desert, bazaars, a camel at sunset, and a genuine wildlife encounter at the end.

Eleven days gives it room. The long drives across the state are spaced out and broken, every city gets two nights, and the safari comes last, so that the trip ends on something wild rather than something crowded. Every transfer, guide and reservation is handled.

Journey Highlights

- **Take** the complete first-time-in-India route — the Taj Mahal, three great Rajasthani cities, the Thar Desert and a wildlife safari — in one seamless trip.
- **Stay** in a mix of heritage havelis and palace-style hotels, which in Rajasthan is the point rather than the extra.
- **Ride** a camel across the Sam sand dunes at sunset, with folk music and dance under the stars afterwards.
- **Track** leopards at Jawai, a landscape of granite hills, banyan trees and a lake, increasingly recognised as one of the best places in the world to see them.
- **Travel** at a considered pace, with comfortable drive distances and enough time in each city to explore without rushing.
- **Meet** Rajasthani culture in the round — folk music, desert food, the bazaars and craft traditions that are centuries old.

Itinerary at a Glance

DAY	DESTINATION	SIGNATURE EXPERIENCE
Day 01	**Delhi**	Arrival and an orientation drive
Day 02	**Delhi**	Old and New Delhi
Day 03	**Delhi to Agra**	Agra Fort, then the Taj at sunset
Day 04	**Agra to Jaipur**	Sunrise at the Taj; Fatehpur Sikri en route
Day 05	**Jaipur**	Amer Fort, City Palace, Jantar Mantar, the bazaars

DAY	DESTINATION	SIGNATURE EXPERIENCE
Day 06	**Jaipur to Jodhpur**	To the blue city
Day 07	**Jodhpur**	Mehrangarh Fort, Jaswant Thada, Sardar Market
Day 08	**Jodhpur to Jaisalmer**	West to the golden city
Day 09	**Jaisalmer**	The living fort, the havelis and a desert sunset at Sam
Day 10	**Jaisalmer to Jawai**	Into leopard country; an evening safari
Day 11	**Jawai**	An optional dawn safari, then onward from Jodhpur or Udaipur

Day by Day

Expand all

> Some day descriptions are drafted from the published route and are awaiting the operator's confirmed copy.

Day 01 Delhi — Arrival

Met on arrival and taken to your hotel. Depending on the hour, a relaxed orientation drive past India Gate and the presidential palace at the head of Lutyens' avenue.

Overnight in Delhi

Day 02 Delhi — Old and New

Old Delhi in the morning — the Red Fort, the Jama Masjid, and a rickshaw ride through Chandni Chowk, which is the fastest way to understand how the old city works. In the afternoon, New Delhi: the Qutub Minar, Humayun's Tomb and the Lotus Temple.

Overnight in Delhi

Day 03 Agra — The Taj at Sunset

Drive — 3 to 4 hours

South to Agra. Agra Fort first, the red-sandstone seat of the Mughal court above the Yamuna, and then the Taj Mahal in the last light of the day, which is the first of two visits.

Overnight in Agra

Day 04 Agra to Jaipur — Sunrise, Then Fatehpur Sikri

Drive — 4 to 5 hours

The Taj again at sunrise, before breakfast, when the marble takes colour from the sky and the gardens are nearly empty. Then the road west to Jaipur, stopping at Fatehpur Sikri, Akbar's abandoned red-sandstone capital, on the way.

Explore Jaipur →

Overnight in Jaipur

Day 05 Jaipur — The Pink City

Amer Fort on its hill, with the drive up to the gate by jeep, its mirrored halls and the Sheesh Mahal; then the City Palace, the Jantar Mantar observatory and the Hawa Mahal from the street. The evening is free for Jaipur's bazaars — textiles, gemstones and the handicrafts the city has traded for three centuries.

Explore Jaipur →

Overnight in Jaipur

Day 06 Jodhpur — The Blue City

Drive — 5 to 6 hours

West across the state to Jodhpur, named the blue city for the indigo-washed houses that spill across the old town beneath its fort. The evening is at leisure — the city's pace is easier than Jaipur's, and it is best met slowly from a rooftop.

Overnight in Jodhpur

Day 07 Jodhpur — Mehrangarh

Mehrangarh Fort, one of the largest and best preserved in India, four hundred feet above the city with the blue roofs spread out below. Then Jaswant Thada, the marble memorial to Maharaja Jaswant Singh II, and the Sardar Market around the clock tower, where the city does its shopping.

Overnight in Jodhpur

Day 08 Jaisalmer — The Golden City

Drive — 5 to 6 hours

Further west into the Thar to Jaisalmer, whose honey-coloured sandstone rises from the dunes like something imagined rather than built. Check in, and take the evening on the ramparts as the light goes.

Overnight in Jaisalmer

Day 09 Jaisalmer — The Living Fort and the Dunes at Sam

Jaisalmer Fort is one of the few living forts left in the world — still home to thousands of residents — with intricately carved Jain temples inside its walls. Then the havelis, Patwon Ki Haveli and Nathmal Ki Haveli, whose merchants competed in stone. In the evening, out to the Sam sand dunes for the desert at its most classic: a camel ride across the dunes, the sunset, and folk music and dance under the stars.

Overnight in Jaisalmer

Day 10 Jawai — Into Leopard Country

Drive — about 5 hours

South-east to Jawai, a landscape of granite hills, ancient banyan trees and a shimmering lake, and one of the most extraordinary wildlife destinations in India — leopards live here in remarkable harmony with the Rabari shepherd communities whose villages sit among the rocks. In the evening, a leopard safari across the hills, which are also home to crocodiles, sloth bears and more than a hundred species of birds.

Overnight in Jawai

Day 11 Jawai — A Last Safari and Departure

Drive — about 3 hours to Jodhpur or Udaipur airport

An optional early-morning safari for a final chance at Jawai's leopards, or a quiet walk around the lake to see the migratory birds and the marsh crocodiles. After breakfast, the transfer to Jodhpur or Udaipur airport for your onward flight.

Departure

What's included

- Accommodation — two nights Delhi, one night Agra, two nights Jaipur, two nights Jodhpur, two nights Jaisalmer, one night Jawai
- Private air-conditioned vehicle for all inter-city drives and local sightseeing
- Camel safari at the Sam sand dunes, and one leopard safari at Jawai with permits, jeep and naturalist guide
- Monument entry fees and English-speaking local guides in each city
- Daily breakfast

Typical inclusions for a journey of this shape. The final list is confirmed in your custom quote.

Practical notes

Best time to visit

October to March — warm sunny days, cool nights, and the best of the leopard sightings at Jawai. Rajasthan is not comfortable from April to the monsoon.

Getting there

Arrive at Delhi (DEL). Depart from Jodhpur (JDH) or Udaipur (UDR), both about three hours from Jawai and both connected to Delhi and Mumbai.

What to bring

Comfortable walking shoes for the forts, light layers for the desert evenings, and a camera — Jawai in particular rewards a long lens.

Pace

Moderate. Three long drives of five to six hours across the state, deliberately spaced, with two nights in each of the big cities so nothing is rushed.